



**ajairu**

# **5 AI Use Cases That Pay for Themselves in 90 Days**

A practical guide for UK SMEs ready to put AI to work

AI that pays for itself in 90 days.

# Introduction

AI is not a future concept for large enterprises. It is a practical tool that UK SMEs are using right now to save time, reduce errors, and free their teams from repetitive work. This guide covers five AI use cases with payback timelines of 90 days or less.

For each use case we cover what it is, how it works, typical results, and what it costs to implement. The figures are based on real client work with businesses of 10 to 250 employees.

The point is not AI for its own sake. It is finding the right process where AI can remove a real bottleneck, with a clear return on investment within the first quarter.

| # | Opportunity                           | Cost            | Payback       |
|---|---------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------|
| 1 | Customer Enquiry Triage and Response  | 3,000 to 8,000  | 60 to 90 days |
| 2 | Invoice and Document Processing       | 3,000 to 8,000  | 60 to 90 days |
| 3 | Meeting Notes and Action Item Capture | 2,000 to 5,000  | 30 to 60 days |
| 4 | Content Drafting for Marketing        | 2,000 to 5,000  | 30 to 60 days |
| 5 | Internal Knowledge Base and Search    | 4,000 to 12,000 | 60 to 90 days |

## 1

## Customer Enquiry Triage and Response

### What it is

An AI system that reads incoming customer enquiries, categorises them by urgency and topic, drafts a first response, and routes them to the right person. Customers get an instant acknowledgement and often a useful first answer, while your team handles the complex cases.

### How it works

Enquiries arrive by email, web form, or chat. The AI reads the message, classifies it (sales, support, billing, urgent), drafts a response using your knowledge base and tone of voice, and routes it to the right team member for review. Complex or sensitive cases go straight to a human. Everything is logged.

### Typical results

- 60 to 80 per cent of enquiries get a first response in seconds
- Consistent, on-brand responses every time
- Your team focuses on complex cases, not routine replies

- Full logging and audit trail for compliance

|                                             |                                        |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>BUILD COST</b><br><b>£3,000 to 8,000</b> | <b>PAYBACK</b><br><b>60 to 90 days</b> |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|

**Why bespoke vs off-the-shelf**

If you spend more than 2 hours per day answering routine enquiries, this pays for itself in the first quarter.

## 2

## Invoice and Document Processing

### What it is

AI that reads invoices, receipts, purchase orders, and other business documents, extracts the key data, validates it, and routes it for processing. It handles the repetitive data entry work that eats hours every week.

### How it works

Documents arrive by email, upload, or scan. The AI reads the text, extracts key fields like supplier, amount, date, and line items, checks the data against your rules, and routes it for approval or posts it to your accounting system. Exceptions are flagged for human review.

### Typical results

- 70 per cent reduction in processing time
- Fewer errors than manual data entry
- Faster approval cycles
- Handles high volumes without extra staff

**BUILD COST****£3,000 to 8,000****PAYBACK****60 to 90 days**

### Why bespoke vs off-the-shelf

At 200 documents per week, this typically saves 15 to 20 hours of manual processing time.

## 3

## Meeting Notes and Action Item Capture

### What it is

An AI assistant that joins your meetings (in person or on video calls), captures the discussion, produces structured notes, and extracts action items with owners and deadlines. No more scrambling to take notes while trying to participate.

### How it works

The AI transcribes the meeting, identifies key decisions and action items, assigns them to the right people, and distributes the notes automatically. Action items sync to your task management tool. You get clean, structured notes within minutes of the meeting ending.

### Typical results

- 3 to 5 hours saved per person per week
- Every action item captured with an owner and deadline
- Consistent, structured meeting notes
- Full searchable record of decisions

**BUILD COST****£2,000 to 5,000****PAYBACK****30 to 60 days**

### Why bespoke vs off-the-shelf

For a team of 10, saving 3 hours per person per week is 30 hours per week reclaimed.

4

Content Drafting for Marketing

What it is

An AI system that drafts your marketing content: blog posts, social media updates, email newsletters, and landing page copy. It uses your brand voice and existing content as reference, producing first drafts your team edits rather than starting from scratch.

How it works

You provide a brief or topic. The AI drafts content in your brand voice, referencing your existing materials. Your team reviews, edits, and approves. The system learns from your edits to improve future drafts. Every piece goes through your review process before publication.

Typical results

- 50 to 70 per cent reduction in content creation time
- Consistent brand voice across all content
- Faster turnaround from idea to published piece
- Your team edits rather than writes from scratch

|                                                  |                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <div>BUILD COST</div> <div>£2,000 to 5,000</div> | <div>PAYBACK</div> <div>30 to 60 days</div> |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|

Why bespoke vs off-the-shelf

If you produce 4 pieces of content per week, this typically halves the time your team spends on content.

## 5

## Internal Knowledge Base and Search

### What it is

An AI-powered search system that lets your team find information across all your documents, wikis, emails, and systems by asking questions in plain English. It replaces the hours spent hunting for the right document or asking colleagues.

### How it works

The system indexes your documents, wikis, and knowledge stores. Team members ask questions in plain English and get answers with citations to the source documents. New documents are indexed automatically. Access controls ensure people only see what they should.

### Typical results

- 50 per cent reduction in time spent searching
- Answers in seconds, not minutes or hours
- Reduces repeated questions to colleagues
- Onboarding new staff faster with self-service

**BUILD COST****£4,000 to 12,000****PAYBACK****60 to 90 days**

### Why bespoke vs off-the-shelf

For a team of 20 spending 2 hours per week each searching, that is 40 hours per week of reclaimed time.

Book a free, no-obligation 30-minute discovery call. We will talk through your business, your goals, and where AI can deliver real value in the next 90 days.

**Book a free call: <https://ajairu.ai/contact>**

Email: [hello@ajairu.ai](mailto:hello@ajairu.ai)





## ajairu

AI consulting for UK SMEs.

|         |                             |
|---------|-----------------------------|
| Website | <b>ajairu.ai</b>            |
| Email   | <b>hello@ajairu.ai</b>      |
| Phone   | <b>Available on request</b> |

Visit <https://ajairu.ai/contact> to book a free, no-obligation discovery call. We will talk through your business, your goals, and whether bespoke software makes sense for you right now.